

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The ghosts are harmless.



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you believe in ghosts? Why or why not?
- Have you heard any ghost stories? What are they about?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences, strange events, and superstitions.
- I can talk about what was happening when something else happened.
- I can express possibility and certainty.





Let's Explore!

A hotel owner gets interviewed by a person from **Mystery*** Magazine. Why is his hotel famous?

* A "mystery" is an unexplained event.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Interviewer: Good morning, Mr. Rose, I'm Francis Burton with Mystery Magazine. Thank you for speaking with me.

Brian Rose: The pleasure is mine. I was just reading your latest edition. I'm a big fan.

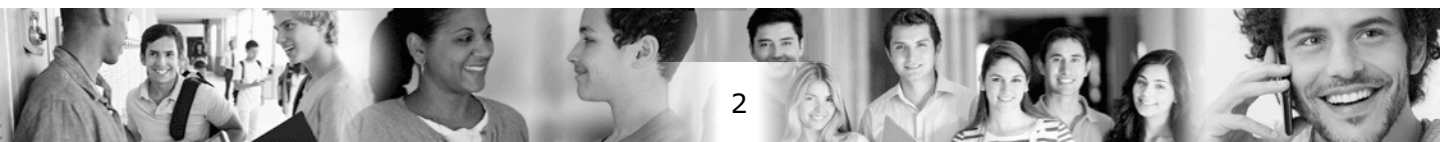
Interviewer: Oh, thank you. Mr. Rose, you are the owner of the Q Hotel which people have heard of thanks to rumors of a supernatural presence. In the words of one past guest, "It's a nice place to stay, even though there are ghosts!" Could you touch on that?

Brian Rose: Yes. It's true that the hotel is haunted, although the ghosts are harmless. About 20 years ago, a mother and daughter died in a fire while they were staying in room 609. They had run away with each other and were hiding out in the hotel. The owner at that time backed out of a promise to keep them safe and told people they were there. It was never proven, but people believe the fire was meant for them. Sometimes, out of nowhere, we might see them in the halls or may hear laughter emanating from room 609.

Interviewer: Does anyone ever check in to room 609?

Brian Rose: I keep the room closed, because I want people to have a peaceful stay. But the ghosts don't hurt anybody. Guests stay at my hotel because they could come across the ghosts.

Interviewer: Well, I'm sure our readers must be curious to experience this for themselves. Mr. Rose, thank you for your time. And stay safe!





Let's Practice!

Not many people would like to spend a night at this hotel.

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the correct words.

1. I _____ your latest edition of Mystery Magazine.
(was just reading / simply read / just reading)
2. About 20 years ago, a mother and daughter _____ in a fire while they were staying in room 609.
(was dying / die / died)
3. They had run away with each other and _____ out in the hotel.
(were hiding / just hiding / hidden)
4. I think there was a ghost because laughter _____ from room 609.
(was emanating / emanates / had emanated)
5. Last weekend, a guest _____ the ghost when she was leaving her room.
(come across / was coming across / came across)



Let's Practice!

Listen closely to Mr. Rose and the interviewer.

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the correct words.

must be / they could / Could you / You may hear /
we might see

1. _____ touch on that?
2. Sometimes, out of nowhere, _____ them in the halls.
3. _____ laughter emanating from room 609.
4. Guests stay at my hotel because _____ come across the ghosts.
5. I'm sure our readers _____ curious to experience this for themselves.





Extension Activity

Research an old ghost story from England, the U.S. or Canada.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find a ghost story from an English-speaking country.
- Read the story and take some notes.
- Retell the story to a friend.
- Discuss with a friend whether or not you believe the story.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I read a ghost story.

☐ ☐

I retell the story using past tenses.

☐ ☐

I discuss the strange coincidence or event.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- rumor** (noun): a story that lacks solid basis and is unlikely to be true
e.g. People have heard of rumors of a supernatural presence.
- supernatural** (adjective): related to what is beyond natural or difficult to explain by natural law
e.g. People talk about a supernatural presence in the hotel.
- presence** (noun): a spirit that cannot be seen but is felt to be near
e.g. There is a supernatural presence in the hotel.
- ghost** (noun): the spirit of a dead person which some people think they can feel or see in a place
e.g. Guests could come across the ghosts at my hotel.
- harmless** (adjective): without the power to hurt anyone
e.g. The hotel is haunted, although the ghosts are harmless.
- haunted** (adjective): inhabited or visited by ghosts
e.g. The hotel is said to be haunted.
- out of nowhere** (expression): appears suddenly; without warning
e.g. Sometimes, out of nowhere, we see ghosts in the halls of the hotel.
- to emanate** (verb): to come from a particular place
Example: You may hear laughter emanating from room 609.





Learning Points

Inseparable Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verbs are two-part verbs consisting of a verb followed by an adverb particle (these look like prepositions, but do not have the same function in phrasal verbs). In some cases, it is not possible to separate the verb and the particle. These are called *inseparable* phrasal verbs.

It is important to remember that the meaning of a phrasal verb is often very different from the two parts taken separately.

For example:

Matt **turned up** last night (= appeared, not the same as turned + up).

To *turn up* is an inseparable phrasal verb. You cannot put an object between the verb and the particle. It must remain together.

Another example is *to get off*.

You can say "**get off** the bus", but you cannot say "**get** the bus **off**".

Some verbs can be used with both a particle and a preposition. This makes them **three-part verbs**.

For example:

to run away with (to leave; to escape from)

to watch out for (to be careful for)

Learning phrasal verbs is a lot like learning new vocabulary. You must memorize which phrasal verbs are inseparable and learn their meanings.

Look at the chart for some more inseparable phrasal verbs and their meanings.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Phrasal Verb	Meaning
<i>come across</i>	find accidentally	<i>hear of</i>	learn about (sometimes accidentally)
<i>come by</i>	find accidentally	<i>check in</i>	register at a hotel
<i>turn into</i>	become	<i>back out of</i>	fail to keep a promise
<i>touch on</i>	mention briefly	<i>run away with</i>	leave with; escape with





Learning Points

Examples:

- *You are the owner of the Q Hotel which people have heard of thanks to rumors of a supernatural presence.*
- *Could you touch on that?*
- *The owner at that time backed out of a promise to keep them safe.*
- *They had run away with each other.*

The Simple Past and The Past Continuous Tenses

You often use the Simple Past and the Past Continuous tenses together.

You can use the Past Continuous tense to refer to the context of a story. It talks about the 'background' action, or the longer action. You use it to talk about an action that was in progress in the past.

*I **was** just **reading** the latest edition of Mystery Magazine.*
*While **they were staying** in room 609 ...*

You can use the Simple Past tense to refer to a shorter action that happened in the middle of, or interrupted, the longer action.

*A mother and daughter **died** in a fire ...*
*The owner **told** people they were there.*

Examples:

- *About 20 years ago, a mother and daughter died in a fire while they were staying in room 609.*
- *They were hiding out in the hotel.*
- *I was just reading your latest edition.*

